Press coverage: what works

For the press secretary · Data as of Nov 5, 2026 · Ratings show how sure each finding is

Eight things to do

1. **Send a release at every bill introduction and every signing, small bills included.** Introductions with a release were covered 88% of the time, against 5% without one. Signings with a release were always covered (median 5 stories); without one, 58% were covered (median 1). MEDIUM-HIGH
2. **Stop sending releases that don't earn coverage.** Honors and awards: 1 of 7 got any story. "Passes the Assembly" outside food safety: median 1 story. Housing: 24 releases, median 1. District and community: 18 releases, 18 stories in total. Make floor votes a social post instead. MEDIUM
3. **Put the news in the title.** Releases with "first", "landmark" or "nation" in the title were picked up 97% of the time (median 13 related stories), against 72% (median 2) for the rest. Releases that name a bill: 81% against 59%. Part of this is the subject itself. MEDIUM
4. **Issue on Monday or Tuesday; avoid Wednesday and Thursday.** Monday releases were picked up 95% of the time, Wednesday 59% and Thursday 71% (ordinary releases, 2021 on, food safety left out). Friday releases get picked up but the stories land about 3 days later. Avoid the end-of-session crush in the second week of September. LOW-MEDIUM
5. **Work the reporters who cover him now; the old list is out of date.** The Bee's state desk has turned over (Lara Korte and Andrew Sheeler have written nothing on him since 2024). Most active in the last 12 months: Andrew Graham and Stephen Hobbs (Bee), Madeline Shannon (Center Square), Yue Stella Yu (CalMatters), Blake Jones and Melanie Mason (Politico), Linh Tat (SCNG), and Sacramento TV (KCRA, ABC10, FOX40). Give AP and CalMatters first looks: each AP story ran in about 20 other outlets, each CalMatters story in about 7. HIGH
6. **Make the Budget Chair role a story about him.** 358 budget stories since 2024, but only 12% feature him and 5% are positive; there were 17 budget releases against 393 budget stories in all. Offer background briefings before the January proposal, the May Revise and the June deal, and one budget op-ed per cycle. MEDIUM-HIGH
7. **Keep a 60–120-word Gabriel quote in every release.** Stories tied to a release quote him 69% of the time, against 35% for other stories. Quotes of that length get picked up most and are reused most. The 15 releases with no quote were picked up 47% of the time, but they were mostly weak kinds anyway. MEDIUM
8. **Give the district and in-language press something they can use.** District and Valley outlets carry 4% of his stories (157). Non-English outlets carry 11% (Spanish 179, Chinese 113, Korean 49), and 74% of those stories follow an English story rather than a release, because releases go out only in English. Add a translated quote on relevant bills for Sing Tao (rising: 10 stories in 2026), La Opinión, Telemundo 52, Univision 34 and Korea Daily, and a local angle for the LA Daily News and SFV Sun. MEDIUM

Key numbers

Measure	Value	Confidence
Releases with at least one story	75% (178 of 236); 40 got nothing	MEDIUM-HIGH
Stories per release	median 2; food safety median 20	MEDIUM
How fast coverage follows a release	78% by the next day; 91% within a week	MEDIUM
Share of all stories tied to a release (2021 on)	36%	MEDIUM
Food safety share of stories	23% (891); AB 418 alone 470 + 609 reprints	HIGH
Stories per year (2023 / 2024 / 2025 / 2026 so far)	764 / 714 / 642 / 607	MEDIUM
Share of stories that quote him (2023 → 2026)	52% → 41%	MEDIUM-HIGH
Tone (Neutral / Positive / Negative)	79% / 16% / 5%; 2026 the most positive year	MEDIUM
Negative coverage concentrates in	guns (17% negative); California Globe	MEDIUM
Top outlets, last 12 months	Politico 42 (incl. Pro), Bee 30, Sacramento TV 22, CalMatters 17, Jewish Journal 16	MEDIUM
September + October share of the year's stories	33%; November–February quiet	HIGH
Stories reprinted at least once	25%, 3.8 reprints each on average	MEDIUM-HIGH
Op-eds by Gabriel since 2018	4 (2026 CalMatters op-ed with Josh Hoover ran in 7 more outlets)	HIGH

Where the tracker undercounts

- **LA Times:** 28 → 17 → 2 stories (2024 → 2026). It blocks the web search, so this is mostly missed stories, not lost coverage. LOW
- **TV:** 84 → 36 stories a year (2023 → 2026). Partly real (LA stations: KTLA 1, ABC7 LA 0 in 2026), partly segments the search can't see. Check against the office's booking log before setting goals. LOW-MEDIUM
- **Spanish local press** (Adelante Valle, La Opinión) looks quieter, but it came mostly through NewsBank, which has thinned. Don't present it as a real decline.
- **The newest weeks** are about 80–85% complete until the monthly NewsBank download.

Track each quarter

- Bills with a release at introduction and at signing (goal: all of his bills).
- Releases picked up (now 75%; goal 80%+).
- Budget stories that feature him (now 12%; goal 20%+).
- District and Valley stories (now 4%; goal: a clear rise).
- Stories that quote him (now 41%; goal: back above 50%).
- LA TV and radio stories, compared with the office's own bookings.

How sure: HIGH the pattern is clear and would hold with complete data. MEDIUM the direction is right but the size may be off. LOW worth testing, not a rule. The figures show what goes together, not proof of cause: big bills get both more releases and more coverage.

Sources: Coverage, Press releases and Bills tabs of the office tracker (fingerprint 3a98feb1), Nov 5, 2026. "Stories" counts originals only, leaving out verbatim release copies; reprints are counted separately. Tone is rated by Claude (the AI the tracker uses) with a written rubric.